

0:0:0.0 --> 0:0:0.360

INTERVIEWER - MW

OK.

0:0:2.40 --> 0:0:8.470

INTERVIEWER - MW

All set. So the first question is kick things off is what does occupational stress mean to you?

0:0:10.570 --> 0:0:11.290

FR08

Um.

0:0:13.310 --> 0:0:18.550

FR08

Well, so obviously a firefighter paramedic for [OVER TWO DECADES]

0:0:20.100 --> 0:0:24.800

FR08

I guess to me it encompasses probably a little bit more

0:0:25.910 --> 0:0:32.90

FR08

On not only like the runs and the not sleeping and the like

0:0:33.40 --> 0:0:45.250

FR08

Just never knowing what we're going to get into. You know, we're gonna fire run, we're gonna have a medic run and you know, whatever. We're gonna be doing, but also on how it affects the guys that I work with.

0:0:45.960 --> 0:0:56.720

FR08

So I feel like the empathy towards that. So I see a lot of that and a lot of changes from when we first started until especially the last three years. I mean it's been just

0:0:58.20 --> 0:0:59.730

FR08

Unbelievably stressful.

0:1:1.480 --> 0:1:2.870

FR08

Since obviously COVID.

0:1:4.170 --> 0:1:26.310

FR08

And for a while, when we didn't, you know, everybody wasn't going to the hospital and it was kind of calm, but we didn't know what was gonna happen. And if our whole, you know, team was gonna get covid and get, you know, out for a month or whatever. And we had a couple guys ended up in the hospital and you know, all that stuff added on and added on and added on. And now I think just the

0:1:27.870 --> 0:1:40.240

FR08

That all kind of stopped and people are wanting to go back to the hospital and hospitals are getting overcrowded and they're stressed out and we can feel that. So it's kind of encompassing everything, not just

0:1:41.30 --> 0:1:47.930

FR08

What I do daily, if that makes sense, and then we all have lives outside of there, so you try not to bring that in, but

0:1:48.710 --> 0:2:4.330

FR08

You know, sometimes you can't help it and you know the guys that you work with are supportive of that. And we're, you know, reciprocating that if they have a bad day. So I think it's way bigger than just, you know, what actually happened at

0:2:5.290 --> 0:2:12.850

FR08

The station during you know on our run or it's almost like a 24/7 thing.

0:2:16.490 --> 0:2:19.690

INTERVIEWER - MW

I get that. I mean that's it is wild. You guys are. It's always.

0:2:21.160 --> 0:2:37.210

INTERVIEWER - MW

You're always in it, you know, depending on what's happening from a bigger standpoint, like there you guys are front and center in the most tense situations. What would from your standpoint, would be helpful to you from like a stress reduction while on the job?

0:2:37.690 --> 0:2:39.0

FR08

We just started

0:2:40.250 --> 0:2:44.400

FR08

A yoga program, she comes in [ONCE A WEEK]. Now it's not

0:2:45.660 --> 0:2:56.280

FR08

It's not like an off the clock thing, so sometimes you miss it cause you have a run, but that hour that she's with us, it changes the whole demeanor of everybody.

0:2:57.30 --> 0:3:3.450

FR08

Even if somebody doesn't necessarily believe in the yoga and all that stuff, just the breathing and just the like

0:3:4.170 --> 0:3:11.470

FR08

Being able to take, you know, a couple minutes out and just kind of concentrate on you, I think that is

0:3:12.460 --> 0:3:14.440

FR08

That's super huge and

0:3:15.170 --> 0:3:45.30

FR08

You know, we're obviously learning how to do that. I've never done it before, so that that's definitely helping. I wish we could obviously do it more often, but that knowing [ONCE A MONTH, AT A SPECIFIC TIME]. So we work every third Thursday. We know we have that hour of time where we can kind of just relax and kind of get into, OK. It's me, I'm OK and you know kind of calm down a little bit, take some of that away.

0:3:45.890 --> 0:3:48.320

INTERVIEWER - MW

Ohh how's how's participation been in that?

0:3:49.270 --> 0:3:54.610

FR08

On my day it's been really good. Obviously runs get in the way.

0:3:55.810 --> 0:4:4.440

FR08

We're typically busy until noon and then we're calm until midnight, and then we run all night. My

0:4:5.700 --> 0:4:19.400

FR08

Station is up in like Mirror Field, so everybody's gone during the day and then everybody comes home at night. So we're our stations, typically busy all night long. So we we've been OK.

0:4:20.850 --> 0:4:24.880

FR08

To get those in lately, tomorrow we'll see again, but.

0:4:25.400 --> 0:4:31.130

FR08

Umm. If if everybody's in the station, everybody's been doing it. So that's been awesome.

0:4:32.120 --> 0:4:33.500

INTERVIEWER - MW

OK, man, that's-

0:4:32.890 --> 0:4:40.580

FR08

And we have all sorts of, you know, from 60 down to 25. So we have all sorts of ages and

0:4:41.580 --> 0:4:45.710

FR08

It it's nice that everybody you know gives it a chance, at least.

0:4:46.900 --> 0:4:50.570

INTERVIEWER - MW

And that's all volunteer like people are choosing to participate?

0:4:48.790 --> 0:4:57.390

FR08

Yeah, yeah. You don't. You don't have to do it, but we definitely have to work out. We do a a. We're have to work out 45 minutes a day.

0:4:58.70 --> 0:4:58.350

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:4:58.450 --> 0:5:1.530

FR08

That's mandatory, but the yoga is not necessarily mandatory.

0:5:3.620 --> 0:5:6.970

INTERVIEWER - MW

What do you think about? What? Is it about the yoga that has people, at least?

0:5:7.980 --> 0:5:10.130

INTERVIEWER - MW

Curious enough to continue engaging in it.

0:5:10.860 --> 0:5:15.320

FR08

I think it's the somebody teaching us how to actually like.

0:5:16.440 --> 0:5:35.170

FR08

Calm down for a second. I feel like we're always up here constantly up here. Even if you're, you know, just eating dinner. And we never know what the next run is gonna be. We, you know, typically you don't sleep very well even when you're home. So you're always kind of up here and that kind of brings you down a little bit. And it's so nice to just have that calmness

0:5:35.860 --> 0:5:40.110

FR08

For a minute and have somebody talk you through breathing and talk you through being calm and

0:5:40.990 --> 0:5:43.930

FR08

It's a lot of stretching, which obviously we all need that

0:5:44.690 --> 0:6:5.320

FR08

And that really helps. And then we can kind of do that on our own then throughout the week, kind of remember some of those things. It would be awesome if we could have something where we could, you know, say we're having a bad day and we could just plug in and say, OK, today I'm gonna do this and I'll feel better afterwards and but we don't really have access to that yet.

0:6:6.170 --> 0:6:14.750

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, OK, that's cool. What about- describe a time a scenario where you feel overwhelmed during your job.

0:6:17.400 --> 0:6:18.200

FR08

Umm.

0:6:21.960 --> 0:6:24.390

FR08

More recently I had a

0:6:25.80 --> 0:6:26.200

FR08

Run in with

0:6:27.10 --> 0:6:34.970

FR08

I mean, to be completely honest, I had a run in with a Battalion Chief and he did something that was completely out of line and

0:6:35.790 --> 0:6:36.530

FR08

Umm.

0:6:37.710 --> 0:6:38.190

FR08

Had.

0:6:39.840 --> 0:6:42.30

FR08

I've been seeing a

0:6:42.810 --> 0:6:44.850

FR08

Psychologist for it and

0:6:46.110 --> 0:7:5.640

FR08

Like it affected- Thankfully my whole entire crew was there and it affected everybody on my team and

so that has created these feelings where I've never, you know, been before. I've had panic attacks. I've had like, it's just been, it's been a terrible situation.

0:7:7.80 --> 0:7:26.930

FR08

So that part of it is probably the worst thing that's happened. You know, we've had bad runs where, you know, a child dies or- But those things like you try your best and you know that you did your best and it kind of get over it. This was something that I had no control over. So that's part of the issue. And so that's definitely

0:7:27.470 --> 0:7:30.100

FR08

Umm, that's my biggest struggle right now.

0:7:30.980 --> 0:7:36.320

FR08

For sure, which was not run-related. That was like work-related so.

0:7:36.880 --> 0:7:37.160

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right.

0:7:38.90 --> 0:7:42.630

INTERVIEWER - MW

But that's all part of it. You know, it's when you're actually doing and who you're relating-

0:7:40.280 --> 0:8:6.740

FR08

Oh yeah, for sure, and it affects home. It affects my [SPOUSE] also does this. So [SPOUSE] works today. I work tomorrow and then we'll all be home on [THE NEXT DAY]. So the kids always have some. One of us here. But every third day is the only time we all have all family here. So, you know, makes hard for holidays and stuff. So we have a little bit of different dynamic than most people, but at least [SPOUSE] understands then too.

0:8:7.710 --> 0:8:10.530

FR08

So it that helps definitely.

0:8:11.440 --> 0:8:12.430

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:8:11.510 --> 0:8:19.550

FR08

He gets it and then I get it when he's, you know, when he's up all night. Then I can, you know, be sympathetic to that and stuff. So I understand both sides of it.

0:8:20.730 --> 0:8:23.350

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, yeah, you guys definitely have a unique family

0:8:24.130 --> 0:8:26.870

INTERVIEWER - MW

Because I'd be curious to see how many

0:8:27.540 --> 0:8:30.440

INTERVIEWER - MW

Firefighter couples there are out there that have a family.

0:8:29.630 --> 0:8:32.640

FR08

There is not very. [ITS RARE]

0:8:34.320 --> 0:8:36.330

FR08

They're not very many at all.

0:8:37.300 --> 0:8:37.890

FR08

So.

0:8:39.730 --> 0:8:40.60

INTERVIEWER - MW

It's.

0:8:40.510 --> 0:8:47.550

INTERVIEWER - MW

Have that relatability at the end of the day, you know, someone don't think you're going crazy. They're like, OK, yeah, I understand that.

0:8:46.560 --> 0:9:16.480

FR08

Right right and we try not to do a bunch of like we give you know 10-15 minutes right after your shift and then we kind of try and do something else, so that we're not constantly thinking about it and counseling. But if something comes up. Obviously we're receptive to. Hey, Oh yeah. I forgot to tell you about this, or what do you know hey we gave this medicine? What do you think about that or you know? Whatever happens to be if you think about something that's fine. But we try not to like dwell on it all day long. So it doesn't affect the only day that we get together so.

0:9:19.120 --> 0:9:19.540

FR08

Yeah.

0:9:16.490 --> 0:9:20.630

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, you guys are literally be working all the time, whether you're on the clock or not.

0:9:20.770 --> 0:9:21.150

FR08

Yeah.

0:9:22.370 --> 0:9:23.720

INTERVIEWER - MW

That's. Do you have any

0:9:25.40 --> 0:9:28.350

INTERVIEWER - MW

Any, chronic work related pain or issues that?

0:9:30.160 --> 0:9:33.650

FR08

So in [EARLY 2000], I tore my shoulder in a fire.

0:9:34.710 --> 0:9:43.550

FR08

So that is eventually I'll have to have surgery again. It was fixed, but that is absolutely something that

0:9:44.510 --> 0:9:58.830

FR08

Is chronic every single day I have an issue with it, whether it just be an irritating pain or repetition is my like downfall. So any repetition then I will be the next two days. I'll just be miserable.

0:9:59.690 --> 0:10:4.170

FR08

So I just kind of work around it. I learned how to, you know, lift things different and

0:10:5.230 --> 0:10:24.380

FR08

Ah, I'm not. I'm not quite as strong. The guys are stronger in their upper body. I'm stronger in my lower body. So I, you know, manipulate stuff a little bit different, still can do the job. It's just I have to go about it a little bit different. And knowing that if I do it over and over and over that I will have that pain. So I try and you know

0:10:25.110 --> 0:10:35.800

FR08

Stop or change or take breaks or you know, and I I saw the time and try not to take too many [OVER-THE-COUNTER MEDICATIONS], but sometimes I just can't help it.

0:10:36.530 --> 0:10:36.760

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:10:38.170 --> 0:10:43.240

INTERVIEWER - MW

What opportunities do you see for incorporating well-being resources into your daily workflow?



0:10:46.900 --> 0:10:49.990

FR08

Can you say can you like say it one more time?

0:10:50.340 --> 0:10:55.610

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah. What opportunities do you see for incorporating well-being resources into your daily workflow?

0:10:56.780 --> 0:11:5.740

FR08

So again, if we could do something where even taking 5 minutes to just have a breathing exercise or a stretching exercise.

0:11:6.460 --> 0:11:11.350

FR08

You know, if you come back from a run and it was pretty stressful just taking that time to like

0:11:12.270 --> 0:11:28.740

FR08

Just, you know, take a big breath and get your bearings about you and then, you know, go on with the rest. But I think that definitely it would definitely benefit every single person, even if they say they don't wanna do it like I do. I do feel like it would be important.

0:11:31.160 --> 0:11:36.950

INTERVIEWER - MW

What are some of the barriers you see playing a role in bringing well-being resources into the workplace community

0:11:39.980 --> 0:11:40.480

INTERVIEWER - MW

Best?

0:11:37.670 --> 0:11:54.450

FR08

Oh definitely the guys the, the macho and the yeah, I'm not doing that. That's silly. You know, that kind of thing. But once, just like the yoga, they were like, OK, whatever. I'll try it. And then now they really like it and they feel great afterwards. So I think that.

0:11:55.870 --> 0:12:1.310

FR08

I think that it would just be a mindset change, not necessarily, you know, hey.

0:12:2.10 --> 0:12:7.200

FR08

Let's all you know, and I'm pretty good at getting getting them to do.

0:12:7.860 --> 0:12:8.490

FR08

We have.

0:12:8.570 --> 0:12:31.770

FR08

Umm, just sidetrack, we have family time after meals and nobody's allowed to get up or do dishes or run water or anything. We just chitchat and it can be the dumbest things ever. But it is so important that that may be the only time we get to talk the whole entire day because we're, you know, running to trainings and doing runs and all that stuff. But everybody who.

0:12:32.540 --> 0:12:52.240

FR08

Has done that has always like tried to take it to their station or their department or, you know, whatever, and just just to take that time out and nothing else matters at the moment. We'll get the dishes later, you know, just have that. Have that quiet, you know or joking or whatever it happens to be and just talk and

0:12:53.400 --> 0:12:55.360

FR08

So I feel like

0:12:56.960 --> 0:13:4.590

FR08

I can kind of ease them into, you know, hey, let's do this. You know, let's take 10 minutes and let's try this, you know.

0:13:5.320 --> 0:13:6.530

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah. OK, that's-

0:13:5.820 --> 0:13:8.560

FR08

So I definitely think it would be beneficial for everybody.

0:13:10.350 --> 0:13:10.910

INTERVIEWER - MW

Love that.

0:13:12.320 --> 0:13:18.160

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what are your thoughts regarding the incorporation of mindfulness practice into your daily work life?

0:13:20.230 --> 0:13:22.250

FR08

I would. I would love it.

0:13:22.970 --> 0:13:34.350

FR08

Definitely. Obviously need more guidance on what all like how to go about it and how to incorporate it. But definitely I do think that it would be a great asset.

0:13:37.400 --> 0:13:45.850

INTERVIEWER - MW

So along those lines, what would be your thoughts regarding if it was like an app, so the use of like a stress reduction app during work is is that?

0:13:46.130 --> 0:13:52.640

FR08

That would be awesome. So far we haven't found anything like that. So yes, that would be awesome. There's a couple like

0:13:54.800 --> 0:14:9.590

FR08

Music or, you know, soft, kind of soothing music where you're just kind of- But it doesn't like almost talk you through something. Or if we had a guide, it would be so much easier. And I think it would be

0:14:10.530 --> 0:14:31.420

FR08

A lot more receptive to the guys to hey, all I have to do is click this and it'll kind of walk me through it and then we're done. I think that that would be way better than trying to come up with something like being in the gym when you don't know what to do. You don't know where to start. So if somebody could help you and guide you, I think it would become almost second nature.

0:14:32.920 --> 0:14:35.310

INTERVIEWER - MW

So now that's cool to hear- do you think-

0:14:44.510 --> 0:14:45.40

FR08

Oh yeah.

0:14:46.830 --> 0:14:47.480

FR08

For sure.

0:14:36.480 --> 0:14:47.790

INTERVIEWER - MW

Would there be some receptivity to doing something that was kind of group based? You know, you talk about family like the family time to incorporate into that people think it would have some legs.

0:14:48.130 --> 0:15:6.360

FR08

Yeah, it's always easier to do stuff when you're with somebody else. I mean, if you're just trying to calm down and go to sleep, obviously you're not gonna do it as a group. But if you're if you're setting the time aside as the group to, hey, you know from three to four, we're gonna do this. I think it would be well.

0:15:7.370 --> 0:15:11.680

FR08

Well, more received. If you can do it as the group for sure.

0:15:12.430 --> 0:15:13.460

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, that's good.

0:15:15.430 --> 0:15:15.810

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right.

0:15:12.640 --> 0:15:18.190

FR08

And then nobody feels weird about doing. You know what I mean? You can just everybody's doing it. So it's not a big deal.

0:15:47.790 --> 0:15:48.100

FR08

Yeah.

0:15:19.750 --> 0:15:48.330

INTERVIEWER - MW

That's good to hear because like so traditionally like we've had this program where people come together once a week and it's like for an hour and then they go and kind of do their daily practices and then recently have been kind of putting it into micro bytes within an app. So you can do it more independently. And as we're just thinking about this target audience we're like, is that their balance between being able to independently versus having that community camaraderie piece of it and trying just to see what people's thoughts are around the head.

0:15:49.340 --> 0:15:50.740

INTERVIEWER - MW

In the yeah.

0:15:49.360 --> 0:16:14.450

FR08

I think I think, I mean there be situations where you'd want both, you know, not exclusively just a group or not exclusively, just single. I think that there would be great times where you could do it as a team building and just kind of whole group stress thing. And then if you need extra, or you just have a bad day. You know, hey, I'm gonna go or do it at home or do it, you know, wherever you happen to be. So yeah, I think it's a great idea.

0:16:16.70 --> 0:16:20.410

INTERVIEWER - MW

What are some of the barriers you think to use in a stress reduction app like that during the work day?

0:16:21.230 --> 0:16:21.810

FR08

Umm.

0:16:22.730 --> 0:16:32.500

FR08

I think for us runs would get in the way sometimes, which you know we're pretty used to that. It wouldn't be and if it was something that we could maybe come back to.

0:16:33.400 --> 0:16:35.880

FR08

Umm. Then that would be helpful.

0:16:37.320 --> 0:16:53.340

FR08

We do a lot of training so it would have to be almost after so eight to four is usually like our work day. We have trainings you know we go to the store, we cook, we clean up after that we prep for dinner. So it would have to be

0:16:54.430 --> 0:16:55.360

FR08

Fit in

0:16:56.70 --> 0:16:57.560

FR08

As a group session.

0:16:58.380 --> 0:17:8.970

FR08

Which, you know, we could do it, that would probably hinder some people that they'll be like, well, 5:00 o'clock, you know, it's my time now. I don't wanna do anything as a group but

0:17:9.680 --> 0:17:14.940

FR08

I think if you could, if you could get it to where it was easily accessible then it would be

0:17:16.420 --> 0:17:17.770

FR08

You know, well received.

0:17:19.820 --> 0:17:34.400

INTERVIEWER - MW

You made a point, I'm curious to see your thoughts. You talk about the training. Would something like this- Would it have to feel distinctly different than training? There's like, is there like a sense of training fatigue that happens within the team or what do you think?

0:17:35.130 --> 0:17:42.570

FR08

No, I don't think this would be considered- because we don't necessarily think that- even though the yoga is a like a

0:17:43.240 --> 0:18:1.430

FR08

Scheduled training thing. I don't feel like it's it's so different than our typical sit there and listen to

somebody, you know, teach us or hands on stuff or it's different than what we're. So I wouldn't think that it would be necessarily consider like a training hinderance if that makes sense.

0:18:1.680 --> 0:18:3.50

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, absolutely.

0:18:2.120 --> 0:18:3.280

FR08

It wouldn't be a.

0:18:4.570 --> 0:18:8.390

FR08

Ohh gosh we have to do this now. You know. I don't think it would come over as that.

0:18:9.130 --> 0:18:9.410

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:18:11.160 --> 0:18:18.40

INTERVIEWER - MW

What information would be important to include in the app if we could blank canvas where we going with it?

0:18:18.650 --> 0:18:21.440

FR08

Umm well right now with like.

0:18:22.770 --> 0:18:33.230

FR08

The the calming and you know, learning how to breathe and learning how to just take take a minute time out and then any sort of

0:18:34.390 --> 0:18:36.270

FR08

Stretching or

0:18:37.20 --> 0:18:51.570

FR08

We do so much physical stuff, even just putting on our gear to go on a fire alarm. I mean, that's you're carrying around 80-90 pounds of stuff. So just to come back and be able to, OK, now I'm gonna, you know.

0:18:52.230 --> 0:18:53.780

FR08

Relax, stretch.

0:18:54.420 --> 0:18:59.460

FR08

You know, think about what ever I need to think about and, you know, try not to think about

0:19:0.570 --> 0:19:2.650

FR08

All the life stuff that's happening maybe.

0:19:4.300 --> 0:19:6.30

FR08

Kind of just guide on that.

0:19:8.720 --> 0:19:13.570

INTERVIEWER - MW

Who- Who do you think should be present in videos, if you're able to watch a video via the the app?

0:19:20.290 --> 0:19:22.40

FR08

I mean, to me, it wouldn't.

0:19:23.630 --> 0:19:26.330

FR08

It could be anybody. I mean, it could be a

0:19:26.940 --> 0:19:31.330

FR08

Fellow like coworker, it could be an instructor, could be

0:19:32.210 --> 0:19:34.940

FR08

Like nature and I guess to me it wouldn't.

0:19:36.950 --> 0:19:38.700

FR08

It depends on, I guess what

0:19:39.550 --> 0:19:52.700

FR08

What it was described, you know what I mean? If it was like physically showing you how to do something, then obviously a person doing it with you would be super helpful. If you don't know how to do that. But you know, if it's just.

0:19:53.620 --> 0:20:2.990

FR08

Related to calming breathing and you know, anti-anxiety stuff. Then you wouldn't necessarily need to necessarily see someone

0:20:4.150 --> 0:20:5.500

FR08

Depending on what it is.

0:20:7.910 --> 0:20:9.260

INTERVIEWER - MW

That's very helpful.

0:20:12.180 --> 0:20:12.670

FR08

So.

0:20:10.70 --> 0:20:14.960

INTERVIEWER - MW

That. That's it. That's all we got. You knocked it out of the park, man. This was.

0:20:15.900 --> 0:20:18.500

INTERVIEWER - MW

This was great. Anything else that

0:20:19.290 --> 0:20:23.300

INTERVIEWER - MW

You felt like we should cover any tidbits? Any parting- Where do you want to leave us with?

0:20:37.440 --> 0:20:37.790

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:20:23.550 --> 0:20:41.490

FR08

No, I like I said, I I feel like it's definitely it would be an awesome resource. I heard that you guys had great feedback from like the nurses and that you've already worked with it. I think it would definitely, definitely benefit if you could get it.

0:20:42.780 --> 0:20:44.340

FR08

Organized and up and running.

0:20:45.860 --> 0:20:52.140

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, I think that's what we're just finding that all the these groups are just unique and then really starting to.

0:20:54.750 --> 0:20:55.50

FR08

Yeah.